that was never something I expected from him. The smile on his face was enough to understand he was pleased with my performance. The day after my speech, however, I went to visit Achrekar Sir, to thank him for all he had done for me, to mark the fact that we had come full circle. It was very important for me to pay my respects in this way.

Sir doesn't speak much these days, but I think that he was happy.

The other thing I did on the day of my retirement was attend a farewell party at the Waterstones club in Mumbai organized by Anjali and my friends Sanjay and Rachna Narang. I have fond memories of the club because it was where Anjali and the Narangs had organized our World Cup celebration party as well. On that occasion, the party was organized overnight and invites sent entirely by text message. This time, however, it was far more elaborate – something I found out later. Friends and well-wishers from around the world had turned up to celebrate my career and we spent a lovely evening together. Some of my closest friends stayed till ten the following morning and we enjoyed reminiscing about the best moments from a twenty-four-year-long career.

West Indies in India 2013

1st Test. Kolkata. 6–8 November 2013

West Indies 234 (MN Samuels 65; M Shami 4–71, R Ashwin 2–52, **SR Tendulkar 1–5**) and 168 (DM Bravo 37, KOA Powell 36; M Shami 5–47, R Ashwin 3–46)

India 453 (RG Sharma 177, R Ashwin 124, **SR Tendulkar 10**; S Shillingford 6–167, V Permaul 2–67)

India won by an innings and 51 runs

2nd Test. Mumbai. 14–16 November 2013

West Indies 182 (KOA Powell 48; PP Ojha 5–40, R Ashwin 3–45) and 187 (D Ramdin 53*, S Chanderpaul 41; PP Ojha 5–49, R Ashwin 4–89)

India 495 (CA Pujara 113, RG Sharma 111*, **SR Tendulkar 74**, V Kohli 57; S Shillingford 5–179, N Deonarine 2–45)

India won by an innings and 126 runs

India won the series 2–0